

THEME 1 · B1+/B2

Sports

1A Thrills and Spills — talking about present activities and events, asking for/giving information, commenting on mistakes

1B Tracing the Roots — national/moral/cultural values in traditional Turkish sports (javelin, Kırkpınar oil wrestling)

Warm-up

Look at the title: Sports. What do you think we will talk about in this theme? Tell your partner two ideas.

VOCABULARY

New words

20 target words

adrenaline

n.



adrenalin

She felt a rush of adrenaline the moment the plane door opened.

thrill-seeker

n.



heyecan arayan kişi

Thrill-seekers often choose sports like bungee jumping or skydiving.

risk-taker

n.



risk alan kişi

Natural risk-takers are often drawn to extreme sports.

extreme sport

n. phrase



ekstrem spor

Wingsuit flying is considered one of the most extreme sports in the world.

stamina

n.



dayanıklılık

Oil wrestlers need enormous stamina to compete for over an hour.

reckless

adj.



pervasız, düşüncesiz

Some people confuse careful risk-taking with reckless behaviour, but they aren't the same.

courage

n.



cesaret

It takes real courage to compete in front of thousands of spectators.

wrestler

n.



güreşçi

Every summer, wrestlers from across Türkiye travel to Edirne to compete.

javelin

n.



cirit

Riders throw the javelin at their opponents as their horses gallop past.

oil wrestling

n. phrase



yağlı güreş

Oil wrestling has been part of Turkish culture for centuries.

take up

phr. v. (transitive)



bir aktiviteye başlamak

He decided to take up rock climbing after watching a documentary.

set up

phr. v. (transitive)



kurmak, düzenlemek

The coach set up a training schedule for the new season.

check out

phr. v. (transitive)



incelemek, kontrol etmek

Before trying a new sport, always check out the safety equipment.

give up

phr. v. (transitive)



vazgeçmek, bırakmak

Many beginners give up climbing after their first fall, but the best athletes don't.

break in

phr. v. (transitive)



yeni bir şeyi kullanıma alıştırmak

Climbers need to break in a new pair of boots before a long expedition.

show off

phr. v. (intransitive)



hava atmak, gösteriş yapmak

He wasn't trying to show off — he genuinely loves the sport.

settle down

phr. v. (intransitive)



sakinleşmek, yerleşmek

After years of extreme sports, she finally settled down and became a coach.

get along

phr. v. (intransitive)



iyi anlaşmak

Teammates in oil wrestling get along well, even though they compete hard.

give in

phr. v. (intransitive)



pes etmek, boyun eğmek

The exhausted wrestler refused to give in, even after an hour of competing.

catch on

phr. v. (intransitive)



yaygınlaşmak, tutulmak

Wingsuit flying has slowly caught on among extreme-sport fans in Türkiye.

Quick game · What's the word?

“kurmak, düzenlemek”

a set up

b stamina

c get along

Quick game · What's the word?

“pervasız, düşüncesiz”

a reckless

b break in

c oil wrestling

Quick game · What's the word?

“iyi anlamak”

a risk-taker

b take up

c get along

Quick game · What's the word?

“yaygınlaşmak, tutulmak”

a get along

b catch on

c risk-taker

Quick game · What's the word?

“yağlı güreş”

a reckless

b oil wrestling

c show off

Quick game · What's the word?

“adrenalin”

a set up

b stamina

c adrenaline

GRAMMAR

Transitive vs Intransitive Phrasal Verbs

Notice

Last year, my cousin decided to **take up** parkour after watching videos online.

The new skater didn't want to **show off**, but everyone was impressed anyway.

It took weeks to **break in** my new climbing boots before the expedition.

After ten years of extreme sports, the champion finally **settled down** and opened a training school.

In which sentences does the phrasal verb need an object (something after it), and in which sentences does it stand alone?

Complete the rule

Look at the Notice sentences again. Complete the rule with the words in the box.

needs an object

doesn't need an object

can be separated

Complete the rule

A transitive phrasal verb (like take up, break in) _____ .

✓ needs an object

Complete the rule

An intransitive phrasal verb (like show off, settle down) _____

•

✓ doesn't need an object

Complete the rule

Some transitive phrasal verbs, like 'take up a hobby' / 'take a hobby up', _____.

✓ can be separated

The rule

Transitive phrasal verbs need an object (take up a sport, set up a camp, check out the equipment, give up a hobby, break in new boots); some can be separated (take a hobby up). Intransitive phrasal verbs are used without an object (show off, settle down, get along, give in, catch on).

TR Geçişli (transitive) phrasal verb'ler bir nesneye ihtiyaç duyar (take up a sport, set up a camp, check out the equipment, give up a hobby, break in new boots). Bazıları ayrılabilir (take a hobby up). Geçişsiz (intransitive) phrasal verb'ler ise nesne almadan tek başına kullanılır (show off, settle down, get along, give in, catch on).

When? We use these phrasal verbs to talk about starting or stopping a sport or hobby, checking equipment, or describing how teammates behave.

TR Bir sporu ya da hobi anlatırken, ekipmanı incelerken ya da bir takım arkadaşlığını tarif ederken bu phrasal verb'leri kullanırız.

Build sentences · Example

she

+

take up / surfing

+

last summer

She took up surfing last summer.

Build sentences

the coach

+

set up / a new training camp

+

for young wrestlers

The coach set up a new training camp for young wrestlers.

Build sentences

I

+

always / check out / the weather forecast

+

before I go paragliding

I always check out the weather forecast before I go paragliding.

Build sentences

he + never / show off + even after winning

He never shows off, even after winning.

Build sentences

the athletes

+

get along / well

+

even though they are rivals

The athletes get along well, even though they are rivals.

Build sentences

? / you

+

ever / give up / a sport

+

because it was too dangerous

Have you ever given up a sport because it was too dangerous?

Your turn

Write four sentences about sports you or someone you know has taken up, given up, shown off in, or how people get along in a team.

I once took up...

I would never give up...

My friend always shows off when...

Our team gets along...

Form

POSITIVE

She took up climbing last year.
He always shows off after a win.

NEGATIVE

They didn't give up, even in the storm.
He doesn't get along with every teammate.

QUESTION

Did you ever take up a dangerous sport?
Does the team get along well?

SHORT ANSWERS

Yes, I did. / No, I never did.
Yes, they do. / No, not really.

Error detective

She took up it two years ago.

a Correct

b Incorrect

✓ **She took it up two years ago.**

Error detective

He showed off his new board to everyone.

a Correct

b Incorrect

✓ He showed off to everyone with his new board. / He showed off in front of everyone.

Error detective

The wrestler didn't give in the match.

a Correct

b Incorrect

✓ The wrestler didn't give in during the match.

A · Choose the correct option.

After the documentary, Ali decided to _____ mountain biking.

a take up

b show off

c get along

A · Choose the correct option.

She never _____ , even when she wins a competition.

a takes up

b shows off

c checks out

A • Choose the correct option.

The new teammates _____ really well from day one.

a get along

b give up

c break in

B · Complete with the correct form.

Before your first dive, always _____ (check out) the equipment carefully.

✓ check out

B · Complete with the correct form.

It can take weeks to _____ (break in) a new pair of climbing shoes.

✓ break in

B · Complete with the correct form.

The exhausted climber refused to _____ (give in), even in the storm.

✓ give in

C · Judge the sentence.

He took up it after watching the Olympics.

a Correct

b Incorrect

✓ **He took it up after watching the Olympics.**

C · Judge the sentence.

She showed off her new skateboard to her friends.

a Correct

b Incorrect

✓ She showed off to her friends with her new skateboard. / She showed off in front of her friends.

C · Judge the sentence.

Wingsuit flying slowly caught on among young athletes.

a Correct

b Incorrect

Dialogue · Complete with the correct phrasal verb.

A: Did you ever _____ (take up) an extreme sport?

✓ **take up**

Dialogue · Complete with the correct phrasal verb.

B: Yes, I _____ (take up) parkour two years ago, but I almost _____ (give up) it after my first injury.

✓ took up / gave up

Dialogue · Reorder the sentence.

along / new / the / teammates / get / well / really

along

well

the

teammates

really

new

get

•
✓ The new teammates get along really well.

GRAMMAR

Simple Present & Present Progressive: Current Sports Trends and Events

Notice

Extreme sports generally **attract** thrill-seekers who love a challenge.

Right now, more and more teenagers **are trying** wingsuit flying for the first time.

Every August, wrestlers from across the country **compete** at Kırkpınar in Edirne.

Look at this footage — the rider **is throwing** the javelin just as his horse gallops past.

Which sentences describe a general fact or habit about sport, and which describe something happening right now or as a current trend?

Complete the rule

Complete the rule with the words in the box.

base verb (+s/es)

is/are + -ing

a general fact or habit

happening now or as a current trend

Complete the rule

For _____, we use the Simple Present: _____.

✓ a general fact or habit / base verb (+s/es)

Complete the rule

For something _____, we use the Present Progressive:
_____ .

✓ **happening now or as a current trend / is/are + -ing**

The rule

Use the Simple Present for general facts, habits and regularly repeated sporting events. Use the Present Progressive (be + -ing) for something happening right now, or a current trend/news item.

TR Genel gerçekler, alışkanlıklar ve düzenli olarak tekrarlanan spor etkinlikleri için Simple Present kullanılır. Şu anda olan bir eylem ya da güncel bir trend/haber için Present Progressive (be + -ing) kullanılır.

When? Use the Simple Present to describe a sport in general or when a traditional event takes place; use the Present Progressive for an action happening now or a current sports trend.

TR Bir sporu genel olarak tanımlarken ya da geleneksel bir etkinliğin ne zaman yapıldığını anlatırken Simple Present; şu anda olan bir hareketi ya da güncel bir spor trendini anlatırken Present Progressive kullanılır.

Build sentences · Example

extreme sports

+

generally / attract

+

thrill-seekers

Extreme sports generally attract thrill-seekers.

Build sentences

more teenagers

+

try

+

wingsuit flying (this year)

This year, more teenagers are trying wingsuit flying.

Build sentences

Kırkpınar wrestlers + compete + every August

Kırkpınar wrestlers compete every August.

Build sentences

look — the rider

+

throw

+

the javelin (right now)

Look — the rider is throwing the javelin right now.

Build sentences

oil wrestling

+

usually / take place

+

in Edirne

Oil wrestling usually takes place in Edirne.

Build sentences

? / interest in extreme sports + grow + among Turkish teenagers

Is interest in extreme sports growing among Turkish teenagers?

Your turn

Write four sentences about sports: one general fact, one current trend or news item, and two sentences about something you or your friends are doing this week related to sport.

Extreme sports generally...

Right now, more people...

This week, I am...

At the moment, our class...

Form

POSITIVE

Oil wrestling takes place every summer.

More people are trying extreme sports this year.

NEGATIVE

Javelin isn't a dangerous sport if the rules are followed.

She isn't competing in this year's tournament.

QUESTION

Does your city have a traditional sports festival?

Is interest in extreme sports growing?

SHORT ANSWERS

Yes, it does. / No, it doesn't.

Yes, it is. / No, it isn't.

Error detective

Right now, more teenagers try wingsuit flying.

a Correct

b Incorrect

✓ Right now, more teenagers are trying wingsuit flying.

Error detective

Wrestlers are competing at Kırkpınar every August.

a Correct

b Incorrect

✓ **Wrestlers compete at Kırkpınar every August.**

A • Choose the correct option.

Oil wrestling _____ place in Edirne every summer.

a takes

b is taking

c take

A • Choose the correct option.

Look! The wrestler _____ his opponent right now.

a grips

b is gripping

c grip

A • Choose the correct option.

This year, interest in extreme sports _____ among teenagers.

a grows

b is growing

c grow

B · Complete with the correct form.

Javelin riders _____ (throw) their sticks as the horses gallop past — that's the traditional rule.

✓ **throw**

B · Complete with the correct form.

Right now, thousands of spectators _____ (watch) the final match.

✓ are watching

B · Complete with the correct form.

_____ your school _____ (organise) any extreme-sport events this term?

✓ Is / organising

C · Judge the sentence.

Right now, the champion is competing in the final round.

a Correct

b Incorrect

C · Judge the sentence.

Kirkpinar wrestlers are competing every August.

a Correct

b Incorrect

✓ **Kirkpinar wrestlers compete every August.**

C · Judge the sentence.

More and more people take up extreme sports this year.

a Correct

b Incorrect

✓ **More and more people are taking up extreme sports this year.**

Dialogue · Complete with Simple Present or Present Progressive.

A: What _____ that rider _____ (do) right now?

✓ is / doing

Dialogue · Complete with Simple Present or Present Progressive.

**B: He _____ (perform) a traditional javelin throw — riders
_____ (do) this every year at the festival.**

✓ is performing / do

Dialogue · Reorder the sentence.

place / Edirne / every / takes / in / summer / Kırkpınar

kırkpınar

Edirne

takes

in

every

summer

place

•

✓ **Kırkpınar takes place in Edirne every summer.**

READING

Born for the Rush?

Before you read

1. Look at the title. What do you think 'born for the rush' means?
2. Do you know anyone who loves risky or exciting activities? What are they like?

BORN FOR THE RUSH? · 1 / 3

Why do some people happily jump out of aeroplanes or ride down a mountain on a board, while others would never dream of it? Decades ago, a psychologist proposed that certain people are simply wired to seek out risk. He called them 'Type T' individuals — the 'T' standing for thrill. According to his theory, these people don't just tolerate danger; they actively look for it.

BORN FOR THE RUSH? · 2 / 3

Scientists who study this idea point to biology as one possible explanation. Type T brains may release dopamine, the chemical linked to pleasure, more strongly during risky activities than an average person's brain does. This could explain why a thrill-seeker's heart races with excitement, not fear, the moment a parachute opens.

BORN FOR THE RUSH? · 3 / 3

Critics warn against judging every risk-taker as reckless, however. Many so-called Type T people take up creative or entrepreneurial paths instead of dangerous sports, channelling the same hunger for novelty into painting, invention or starting a business. Whether on a cliff edge or in a studio, it seems the same restless curiosity can drive very different kinds of lives.

While you read

What is the main idea of the text?

a

Only dangerous sports attract Type T people.

b

Some people may be biologically drawn to risk and novelty, which can show up in different ways.

c

Dopamine makes all risky sports completely safe.

While you read

The psychologist called risk-seeking people _____ individuals.

✓ Type T

While you read

According to the text, what chemical might explain a thrill-seeker's excitement?

a adrenaline only

b dopamine

c stamina

While you read

According to the text, all Type T people become extreme athletes.

a Correct

b Incorrect

✓ According to the text, many Type T people channel their curiosity into other things, like art or business.

While you read

The final paragraph suggests that the same restless curiosity can drive people toward risky sports or toward _____ paths.

✓ creative or entrepreneurial

After you read

1. Do you think you have a 'Type T' personality? Why or why not?
2. Can you think of another non-sporting way someone might channel a love of risk?

READING

Oil, Honour and Forty Springs

Before you read

1. What do you already know about traditional Turkish sports?
2. What do you think the name 'Kırkpınar' might mean?

OİL, HONOUR AND FORTY SPRINGS · 1 / 3

Every July, thousands of spectators travel to Edirne to watch one of the oldest sporting events in the world.

Wrestlers, known as pehlivan, cover their bodies in olive oil and compete on open grass in leather trousers called a kispet. The tournament, known as Kırkpınar, has been held almost every year since 1924, making it a proud symbol of Turkish sporting heritage.

OİL, HONOUR AND FORTY SPRINGS · 2 / 3

The event's name comes from an old legend. Two brothers are said to have wrestled each other for so long, and so evenly matched, that neither could win — until, exhausted, they both collapsed and died on the spot. According to the story, forty springs later bubbled up from the ground where they fell, giving the region its name: Kırkpınar, or 'Forty Springs'.

OİL, HONOUR AND FORTY SPRINGS · 3 / 3

Beyond the oil and the crowds, Kırkpınar is built on respect. Wrestlers bow to their opponents before a match, and the strongest competitor, the başpehlivan, is expected to show humility, not arrogance. Similar values appear in other traditional Turkish sports, such as the horseback javelin game, where courage and fair play matter as much as winning.

While you read

Where does the Kırkpınar tournament take place?

a Istanbul

b Edirne

c Ankara

While you read

Wrestlers in Kırkpınar are known as _____ .

✓ **pehlivan**

While you read

According to the legend, the two brothers both won the wrestling match.

a Correct

b Incorrect

✓ **According to the legend, neither brother won — both collapsed and died.**

While you read

What quality is the başpehlivan (strongest wrestler) expected to show?

a arrogance

b humility

c impatience

While you read

The text says courage and _____ matter as much as winning in the traditional javelin game.

✓ **fair play**

After you read

1. Why do you think respect and humility are so important in this sport?
2. Compare Kırkpınar with a modern sport you know — what values do they share or not share?

LISTENING

My First Jump

Before you listen

1. Predict: how do you think Deniz felt before and after his jump?

My First Jump

Ses kaydı yakında — transkripti öğretmen okuyabilir.

While you listen

What almost happened right before Deniz jumped?

a He fell asleep.

b He nearly asked to go back down.

c He lost his equipment.

While you listen

After the fear passed, Deniz felt a wave of _____ .

✓ **adrenaline**

While you listen

Deniz plans to take up skydiving every week from now on.

a Correct

b Incorrect

✓ **Deniz isn't sure about skydiving regularly, but he wants to try paragliding.**

While you listen

What does Elif mean when she says Deniz is 'turning into a real thrill-seeker'?

a

He is becoming more interested in exciting, risky activities.

b

He is becoming afraid of sports.

c

He is giving up sport completely.

LISTENING

The Javelin Riders

Before you listen

1. What do you predict this traditional game involves — a ball, a stick, or something else?

The Javelin Riders

Ses kaydı yakında — transkripti öğretmen okuyabilir.

While you listen

What is the main topic of Kaan's presentation?

a A modern Olympic sport

b The traditional Turkish javelin game (cirit)

c Oil wrestling in Edirne

While you listen

The javelin game is especially popular at _____ and local festivals.

✓ weddings

While you listen

According to Kaan, the javelin game today usually causes serious injuries.

a Correct

b Incorrect

✓ According to Kaan, it's mostly a cultural event today, not a dangerous competition.

While you listen

What historical purpose did the game serve, according to the presentation?

a It trained young men for combat and helped settle disputes.

b It was only ever played for money.

c It replaced formal schooling.

SPEAKING

Worth the Risk?

In pairs, discuss whether the risks of extreme sports are worth the rewards. Talk about at least two extreme sports, using phrasal verbs (take up, give up, show off, catch on) and both Simple Present and Present Progressive where natural.

SPEAKING

Presenting a Traditional or Extreme Sport

Prepare a two-minute talk about either a Turkish traditional sport (such as Kırkpınar oil wrestling or the javelin game) or an extreme sport you would like to try. Explain what it involves, where and when it takes place, and why it matters or appeals to you.

WRITING

Extreme Sports Magazine Article

Write a short magazine article about an extreme sport of your choice. Start with a clear topic sentence, add at least three supporting sentences with details and examples, and finish with a concluding sentence.

WRITING

A Guide to a Turkish Traditional Sport

Write a short guide persuading an international visitor to watch a Turkish traditional sport (Kırkpınar oil wrestling or the javelin game). Describe what happens and explain why it's worth seeing.

REVIEW

Exit ticket

Exit ticket

After watching the Olympics, Mert decided to _____ archery.

a take up

b show off

c get along

Exit ticket

Oil wrestling _____ place in Edirne every July.

a takes

b is taking

c take

Exit ticket

Look! The riders _____ (gallop) toward each other right now.

✓ are galloping

Exit ticket

She never _____ (show off) after winning a match.

✓ shows off

Exit ticket

This year, interest in wingsuit flying _____ among teenagers.

a grows

b is growing

c grow

Exit ticket

He took up it after his first competition.

a Correct

b Incorrect

✓ **He took it up after his first competition.**

Exit ticket

The wrestler refused to _____ (give in), even when exhausted.

✓ give in

Exit ticket

Which sentence uses the Present Progressive correctly for a current trend?

a More people take up extreme sports these days.

b More people are taking up extreme sports these days.

c More people is taking up extreme sports.

Exit ticket

Which word describes someone who does dangerous things without thinking about the risk?

a reckless

b diverse

c compulsory

Exit ticket

Wrestlers in Kırkpınar are called _____.

✓ pehlivan

Exit ticket

Put the words in order.

takes

in

every

place

Edirne

kırkpınar

summer

•

✓ **Kırkpınar takes place in Edirne every summer.**

Exit ticket

Kırkpınar wrestlers are competing every August.

a Correct

b Incorrect

✓ **Kırkpınar wrestlers compete every August.**

Exit ticket

Rewrite using the correct phrasal verb.

(He started rock climbing two years ago. (take up))

✓ **He took up rock climbing two years ago.**

Exit ticket

It can take weeks to _____ (break in) new climbing boots.

✓ break in